



« We felt we were still a little bit light in our opening batting. And we were also looking at the fact that at some point, MS will move on. Sanju is an international-quality player. So it's succession planning. – Stephen Fleming, CSK head coach »

SQUAD

Wicketkeepers

MS Dhoni, Kartik Sharma, Sanju Samson, Urvil Patel

Batters

Sarfaraz Khan, Matthew Short, Ruturaj Gaikwad, Ayush Mhatre, Dewald Brevis

All-rounders

Aman Khan, Akeal Hosein, Shivam Dube, Prashant Veer, Ramakrishna Ghosh, Shreyas Gopal, Jamie Overton, Zak Foulkes

Bowlers

Anshul Kamboj, Khaleel Ahmed, Matt Henry, Rahul Chahar, Noor Ahmad, Gurjapneet Singh, Mukesh Choudhary, Spencer Johnson

A NEW OPENING SCRIPT

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POWERPLAY CONCERNS

136.41

Lowest batting strike rate in the PowerPlay last season



Chennai Super Kings struggled to get going early in the innings in the previous edition. Openers Rachin Ravindra and Rahul Tripathi endured lean patches, leaving the side playing catch-up. Late additions Urvil Patel and Ayush Mhatre injected energy but arrived too late to change the season's trajectory.

The trade for Sanju Samson, the hero of India's recent T20 World Cup triumph, could significantly improve scoring tempo alongside Ruturaj Gaikwad at the top.

KEY ADDITION

84.00

Sanju Samson's average in the PowerPlay since 2022

The arrival of Sanju Samson from Rajasthan Royals could transform CSK's starts. Since 2022, only Sai Sudharsan has a better PowerPlay average than Samson in IPL.

Samson combines consistency with pace, scoring at 142.85 strike rate vs pace and 151.02 vs spin across the last four seasons. His presence should help CSK build stronger platforms for the middle order.

PLAYER TO WATCH

A high-impact opener capable of dictating the tempo in the first six overs. If Samson settles into the role quickly, he could solve CSK's biggest weakness from the previous season: slow starts.